

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Sania Subedar

Address: 23 South Drive Cheam SM2 7PH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Re: Letter of Support - Planning Application DM2025/01591

Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub), involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Dear Planning Officer,

I am writing to express my wholehearted support for planning application DM2025/01591. I am a local resident living within walking distance of the proposed site, and as a woman and a mother, I feel strongly that this development would make a real and positive difference to the lives of many people in our community.

A Safe and Welcoming Space for Women

One of the aspects of this proposal I feel most strongly about is the provision of dedicated space and activities for women. As a woman living in this area, I know from personal experience how limited the options are for women to come together in a safe, accessible and welcoming environment. This facility would offer exactly that - a place where women of all backgrounds can meet, socialise, access support, and take part in health and wellbeing programmes close to home. That kind of provision has an enormous impact on mental health, social connection and overall quality of life, and it is something our community genuinely lacks at present.

Support for Older Members of the Community

I am also particularly pleased to see that the proposal gives consideration to the needs of older residents. Elderly members of our community often face real difficulties accessing facilities further

afield, whether due to mobility, transport or simply the practicalities of travelling alone. Having a warm, inclusive community hub within easy reach - somewhere familiar and local - would make a meaningful difference to their independence and wellbeing. A space where older people can gather, participate and feel connected to their community is something to be valued and supported.

Thoughtful Planning Around Parking and Peak Times

I understand that parking and traffic concerns are often raised in relation to proposals of this kind, and I want to address this directly. The application includes 12 on-site parking spaces plus 2 dedicated disabled bays, which I consider well suited to the scale and nature of this use. Importantly, the applicants have also made a specific commitment to stagger Friday prayer times across three separate periods precisely in order to spread any peak demand and avoid a concentration of arrivals and departures at any one time. This is a responsible and practical measure that demonstrates genuine consideration for the surrounding neighbourhood. Combined with the provision of cycle storage to encourage sustainable travel, I do not believe this development will give rise to significant traffic or parking issues.

The Consequences of Refusal

I would also respectfully ask the Council to weigh up what this site might become if this application is not approved. A vacant former ambulance station in a residential area does not stay vacant for long. The realistic alternative is that the land is sold for residential development - most likely a block of flats or additional council housing. I want to be clear that I am not opposed to housing in principle, but our area is already feeling the strain. Our local schools, GP practices, and community services are stretched, and any significant increase in the residential population would add further pressure to infrastructure that is already struggling to cope. This proposal, by contrast, brings community benefit without adding to that burden. It serves the people who are already here, rather than creating new demand on resources we can ill afford to stretch further.

A Development Our Community Deserves

This is a modest, well-designed proposal that will provide a genuine hub for our neighbourhood - a place for women to meet and feel safe, for elderly residents to stay connected, for children to learn and grow, and for the wider community to come together. I believe it is exactly the kind of development we should be encouraging.

I respectfully ask the Council to grant planning permission for application DM2025/01591.

Yours faithfully,
Sania Subedar